TEMPLE ARCHITECTURE AND CHANDELLA KHAJURAHO

TEMPLE RITUAL SEQUENCE → REGIONAL MORPHOLOGY → KHAJURAHO POWER-TO-FORM → KHAJURAHO AXIAL CHAIN → MOUNTAIN SILHOUETTE → BREADTH-OF-LIFE LEDGER

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◆ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g3 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00 TEMPLE RITUAL SEQUENCE

TEMPLE RITUAL SEQUENCE · ELEVATED SACRED PLATFORM · CONGREGATIONAL APPROACH · TRANSITION TO SANCTUM · DEITY AND RITUAL FOCUS · MUST REMEMBER · TEMPLE FORM MOVES FROM GUPTA STRUCTURAL EXPERIMENTS TOWARD DIFFERENTIATED · NAGARA, DRAVIDA AND DECCAN SOLUTIONS; KHAJURAHO'S JAGATI, AXIAL HALLS

JAGATI → elevated sacred platform → MANDAPA → congregational approach → ANTARALA → transition to sanctum → GARBHAGRIHA → deity and ritual focus → MUST REMEMBER: Temple form moves from Gupta structural experiments toward differentiated

CORE CLAIM
- JAGATI → elevated sacred platform
- MANDAPA → congregational approach

MECHANISM
- ANTARALA → transition to sanctum
- GARBHAGRIHA → deity and ritual focus

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- MUST REMEMBER: Temple form moves from Gupta structural experiments toward differentiated
- Nagara, Dravida and Deccan solutions; Khajuraho's jagati, axial halls, garbhagriha and clustered shikhara belong within Chandella patronage.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Nagara, Dravida and Deccan solutions; Khajuraho's jagati, axial halls, garbhagriha and clustered shikhara belong within Chandella patronage.

01

STAGE 01 REGIONAL MORPHOLOGY

REGIONAL MORPHOLOGY · CURVILINEAR SHIKHARA · TIERED VIMANA AND ENCLOSURE · SELECTIVE NORTHERN-SOUTHERN GRAMMAR · BRICK, TERRACOTTA AND BANGLA ROOF

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
NAGARA → curvilinear shikhara	DECCAN → selective northern-southern grammar	NAGARA → curvilinear shikhara
DRAVIDA → tiered vimana and enclosure	EASTERN → brick, terracotta and Bangla roof	DRAVIDA → tiered vimana and enclosure

CORE CLAIM
- NAGARA → curvilinear shikhara
- DRAVIDA → tiered vimana and enclosure

MECHANISM
- DECCAN → selective northern-southern grammar
- EASTERN → brick, terracotta and Bangla roof

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- NAGARA → curvilinear shikhara
- DRAVIDA → tiered vimana and enclosure

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DECCAN → selective northern-southern grammar; EASTERN → brick, terracotta and Bangla roof.

02

STAGE 02 KHAJURAHO POWER-TO-FORM

KHAJURAHO POWER-TO-FORM · CHANELLA ASSERTION · VISIBLE PATRONAGE NEED · MAHARAJADHIRAJA CONTEXT · TEMPLE CLUSTER · SOVEREIGNTY IN STONE · NO INVENTED VICTORY DEDICATION

CHANELLA ASSERTION → visible patronage need → DHANGA → maharajadhiraja context → TEMPLE CLUSTER → sovereignty in stone → LIMIT → no invented victory dedication

CORE CLAIM
- CHANELLA ASSERTION → visible patronage need
- DHANGA → maharajadhiraja context

MECHANISM
- TEMPLE CLUSTER → sovereignty in stone
- LIMIT → no invented victory dedication

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CHANELLA ASSERTION → visible patronage need
- DHANGA → maharajadhiraja context

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TEMPLE CLUSTER → sovereignty in stone; LIMIT → no invented victory dedication.

03

STAGE 03 KHAJURAHO AXIAL CHAIN

KHAJURAHO AXIAL CHAIN · ENTRANCE PORCH · GARBHAGRIHA + SHIKHARA · SACRED CLIMAX

ARDHAMANDAPA → entrance porch → MANDAPA → hall → ANTARALA → vestibule → GARBHAGRIHA + SHIKHARA → sacred climax

CORE CLAIM
- ARDHAMANDAPA → entrance porch
- MANDAPA → hall

MECHANISM
- ANTARALA → vestibule
- GARBHAGRIHA + SHIKHARA → sacred climax

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- ARDHAMANDAPA → entrance porch
- MANDAPA → hall

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ANTARALA → vestibule; GARBHAGRIHA + SHIKHARA → sacred climax.

04

STAGE 04 MOUNTAIN SILHOUETTE

MOUNTAIN SILHOUETTE · MAIN SHIKHARA · CENTRAL VERTICAL MASS · CLUSTERED REPLICA SPIRES · RAISED HORIZONTAL BASE · MOUNTAIN-RANGE COMPOSITION

MAIN SHIKHARA → central vertical mass

URUSHRINGAS → clustered replica spires → JAGATI → raised horizontal base → RESULT → mountain-range composition

CORE CLAIM
- MAIN SHIKHARA → central vertical mass
- URUSHRINGAS → clustered replica spires

MECHANISM
- JAGATI → raised horizontal base
- RESULT → mountain-range composition

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- MAIN SHIKHARA → central vertical mass
- URUSHRINGAS → clustered replica spires

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: JAGATI → raised horizontal base; RESULT → mountain-range composition.

05

STAGE 05 BREADTH-OF-LIFE LEDGER

BREADTH-OF-LIFE LEDGER · DEITIES AND WORSHIPPERS · TEACHERS, DANCERS AND MUSICIANS · VYALAS AND NARRATIVE FORMS · MAITHUNA AS ONE REGISTER

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
SACRED → deities and worshippers	IMAGINATIVE → vyalas and narrative forms	SACRED → deities and worshippers
SOCIAL → teachers, dancers and musicians	INTIMATE → maithuna as one register	SOCIAL → teachers, dancers and musicians

CORE CLAIM
- SACRED → deities and worshippers
- SOCIAL → teachers, dancers and musicians

MECHANISM
- IMAGINATIVE → vyalas and narrative forms
- INTIMATE → maithuna as one register

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- SACRED → deities and worshippers
- SOCIAL → teachers, dancers and musicians

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: IMAGINATIVE → vyalas and narrative forms; INTIMATE → maithuna as one register.

06

STAGE 06 CHAUSATH YOGINI DISTINCTION

CHAUSATH YOGINI DISTINCTION · CHANDELLA LANDSCAPE · KHAJURAHO FORM · OPEN-AIR GRANITE ENCLOSURE · NEAR MORENA, KACHCHHAPAGHATA · MITAOLI FORM · CIRCULAR; POPULAR PARLIAMENT LINK

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
KHAJURAHO → Chandella landscape	MITAOLI → near Morena, Kachchhapaghata	KHAJURAHO → Chandella landscape
KHAJURAHO FORM → open-air granite enclosure	MITAOLI FORM → circular; popular Parliament link	KHAJURAHO FORM → open-air granite enclosure

CORE CLAIM
- KHAJURAHO → Chandella landscape
- KHAJURAHO FORM → open-air granite enclosure

MECHANISM
- MITAOLI → near Morena, Kachchhapaghata
- MITAOLI FORM → circular; popular Parliament link

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- KHAJURAHO → Chandella landscape
- KHAJURAHO FORM → open-air granite enclosure

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MITAOLI → near Morena, Kachchhapaghata; MITAOLI FORM → circular; popular Parliament link.

07

STAGE 07 PALLAVA TRANSITION

PALLAVA TRANSITION · ROCK-CUT MANDAPAS · MONOLITHIC PANCHA RATHAS · STRUCTURAL SHORE TEMPLE · CHOLA STRUCTURAL EXPANSION

MAHENDRAVARMAN → rock-cut mandapas → MAMALLA → monolithic Pancha Rathas → RAJASIMHA → structural Shore Temple → LEGACY → Chola structural expansion

CORE CLAIM
- MAHENDRAVARMAN → rock-cut mandapas
- MAMALLA → monolithic Pancha Rathas

MECHANISM
- RAJASIMHA → structural Shore Temple
- LEGACY → Chola structural expansion

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- MAHENDRAVARMAN → rock-cut mandapas
- MAMALLA → monolithic Pancha Rathas

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RAJASIMHA → structural Shore Temple; LEGACY → Chola structural expansion.

08

STAGE 08 CHOLA ACHIEVEMENT SYSTEM

CHOLA ACHIEVEMENT SYSTEM · GRANITE TEMPLE · MONUMENTAL STATE FORM · BRONZE + MURAL · PORTABLE AND PAINTED ART · ADMINISTRATION AND PATRONAGE · LIVING WORSHIP · CONTINUING CULTURAL MEMORY

GRANITE TEMPLE → monumental state form → BRONZE + MURAL → portable and painted art → INSCRIPTION → administration and patronage → LIVING WORSHIP → continuing cultural memory

CORE CLAIM
- GRANITE TEMPLE → monumental state form
- BRONZE + MURAL → portable and painted art

MECHANISM
- INSCRIPTION → administration and patronage
- LIVING WORSHIP → continuing cultural memory

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- GRANITE TEMPLE → monumental state form
- BRONZE + MURAL → portable and painted art

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: BRONZE + MURAL → portable and painted art.

09

STAGE 09 DECCAN EXPERIMENT

DECCAN EXPERIMENT · PATTADAKAL VIRUPAKSHA · DRAVIDA TOWER · PATTADAKAL PAPANATHA · NAGARA TOWER · STELLATE SOAPSTONE DENSITY · DESCRIBE EVIDENCE BEFORE VESARA · CLOSE DISTINCTION

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
PATTADAKAL VIRUPAKSHA → Dravida tower	HOYSALA → stellate soapstone density	CLOSE DISTINCTION: A Nagara sanctum shikhara is not a Dravida gopuram, Vesara is not a mechanical
PATTADAKAL PAPANATHA → Nagara tower	VERDICT → describe evidence before Vesara	half-and-half formula, and Khajuraho's sacred, social and erotic registers cannot be reduced to one motif.

CORE CLAIM
- PATTADAKAL VIRUPAKSHA → Dravida tower
- PATTADAKAL PAPANATHA → Nagara tower

MECHANISM
- HOYSALA → stellate soapstone density
- VERDICT → describe evidence before Vesara

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: A Nagara sanctum shikhara is not a Dravida gopuram, Vesara is not a mechanical
- half-and-half formula, and Khajuraho's sacred, social and erotic registers cannot be reduced to one motif.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: A Nagara sanctum shikhara is not a Dravida gopuram, Vesara is not a mechanical half-and-half formula, and Khajuraho's sacred, social and erotic registers cannot be reduced to one motif.

10

STAGE 10 LATE DRAVIDA SHIFT

LATE DRAVIDA SHIFT · VIMANA-DOMINANT IMPERIAL COMPLEX · RAYA GOPURAM AND MANDAPAS · GRADED GATEWAYS AND PRAKARAMS · PROCESSION, GATHERING AND RITUAL EXPANSION · EVIDENCE LIMIT · STYLE LABELS ORGANISE COMPARISON BUT MATERIAL, PLAN, TOWER, PATRONAGE

CHOLA → vimana-dominant imperial complex → VIJAYANAGARA → raya gopuram and mandapas → NAYAKA → graded gateways and prakarams → FUNCTION → procession, gathering and ritual expansion → EVIDENCE LIMIT: Style labels organise comparison but material, plan, tower, patronage and region must be

CORE CLAIM
- CHOLA → vimana-dominant imperial complex
- VIJAYANAGARA → raya gopuram and mandapas

MECHANISM
- NAYAKA → graded gateways and prakarams
- FUNCTION → procession, gathering and ritual expansion

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: Style labels organise comparison but material, plan, tower, patronage and region must be named
- UNESCO status and conservation claims require a dated official source rather than timeless prestige language.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EVIDENCE LIMIT: Style labels organise comparison but material, plan, tower, patronage and region must be named; UNESCO status and conservation claims require a dated official source rather than timeless prestige language.

11

STAGE 11 TEMPLE ANSWER SPINE

TEMPLE ANSWER SPINE · SCHOOL, DYNASTY AND MONUMENT · PLAN, TOWER, MATERIAL AND ENCLOSURE · PATRONAGE, SCULPTURE AND SOCIETY · COMPARISON, SOURCE LIMIT AND STATUS

NAME → school, dynasty and monument → DESCRIBE → plan, tower, material and enclosure → ANALYSE → patronage, sculpture and society → QUALIFY → comparison, source limit and status

CORE CLAIM
- NAME → school, dynasty and monument
- DESCRIBE → plan, tower, material and enclosure

MECHANISM
- ANALYSE → patronage, sculpture and society
- QUALIFY → comparison, source limit and status

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- NAME → school, dynasty and monument
- DESCRIBE → plan, tower, material and enclosure

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ANALYSE → patronage, sculpture and society; QUALIFY → comparison, source limit and status.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · UNESCO'S KHAJURAHO GROUP OF MONUMENTS PROPERTY REMAINS INSCRIBED · PRESENTING MITHUNA/EROTIC SCULPTURE AS UNIQUE TO KHAJURAHO. - THE · TREATING EVERY KHAJURAHO TEMPLE'S ORIENTATION, SCALE OR DEDICATION AS · CONFUSING THE NUMBER OF SURVIVING KHAJURAHO TEMPLES WITH THE · ATTRIBUTING A SPECIFIC NAMED TEMPLE TO A SPECIFIC CHANDELLA · REPEATING THE TEXTBOOK'S CIRCULAR-PLAN DESCRIPTION FOR KHAJURAHO'S · TREATING "VESARA" AS A SETTLED, SELF-EXPLANATORY CATEGORY. - USE

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH
- UNESCO's Khajuraho Group of Monuments property remains inscribed
- NOT: Presenting mithuna/erotic sculpture as unique to Khajuraho. - The
- NOT: Treating every Khajuraho temple's orientation, scale or dedication as
- NOT: Confusing the number of surviving Khajuraho temples with the current

ADVANCED DEBATE
- NOT: Attributing a specific named temple to a specific Chandella ruler
- NOT: Repeating the textbook's circular-plan description for Khajuraho's
- NOT: Treating "Vesara" as a settled, self-explanatory category. - Use it
- NOT: Silently normalising "Chandella" to "Chandela" (or vice versa) when

LEGACY / NUANCE
- NOT: Medieval History owns the detailed Chandella-Pratihara-Pala
- NOT: Society/Gender Studies owns a doctrinal or normative reading of
- CAUTION: Conservation, tourism and integrity trade-off (examiner angle):
- Cross-links: Topic 06 (sculptural technique/iconographic reading

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels